Project Report: Digital Literacy Portfolio

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

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Introduction

This project serves as a comprehensive portfolio for the Digital Literacy course, designed under the persona of a Student Digital Ambassador. The primary objective is to demonstrate proficiency in navigating the modern digital landscape—from professional identity management to online safety. Over the course of five modules, I have developed resources to help my peers communicate responsibly and utilize digital tools effectively. This report documents the creation of an awareness infographic, the establishment of a professional digital footprint, the exploration of technical collaboration platforms, the mastery of formal email etiquette, and a deep dive into cybercrime prevention. All deliverables are hosted in a centralized GitHub repository to ensure transparency and long-term accessibility.

Task 1 : Infographic

To fulfill the first task, I created a visual infographic using Canva aimed at educating my batchmates on the core pillars of digital literacy. My design specifically highlights Topic 1, What is Digital Literacy, Topic 2 , Professional Online Presence, and Topic 3, Safe internet practices. I chose a minimalist layout to ensure that complex information is easily digestible at a glance.

During the design process, I found it particularly interesting to see how visual hierarchy can direct a reader's attention to the most critical safety tips first. One difficulty I encountered was condensing a large amount of information into a single page without making it look cluttered. Overcoming this required me to prioritize need-to-know facts over nice-to-know details, a skill that is essential for effective digital communication.

Task 2 : Digital Portfolio

In this module, I focused on building a foundational professional presence by setting up accounts on LinkedIn, Kaggle, and GitHub. On GitHub, I initialized a profile README that introduces my academic background and my specific learning aspirations for the B.Tech program. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my current status at VIT Bhopal.

These platforms serve distinct but complementary purposes: GitHub acts as a live gallery of my technical projects, while LinkedIn facilitates networking with industry

professionals and alumni. Over the next four years, I plan to use these tools to document every major project and certification I earn. By maintaining these profiles early on, I am ensuring that by the time I reach my final year, I will have a rich, verifiable history of my growth to present to potential internship coordinators and employers.

Task 3 : Platforms

For the technical exploration task, I engaged with two different digital environments. First, I used HackerRank to solve a beginner-level coding challenge, specifically Solve Me First. This exercise provided hands-on experience with automated evaluation systems and competitive coding logic. Second, I utilized Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my peers. This quiz includes five questions, featuring both multiple-choice and short-answer formats to gauge student understanding of online safety.

These tools are vital for my academic success as they bridge the gap between individual practice and team-based projects. Coding platforms will help me prepare for technical interviews, while cloud collaboration tools like Google Workspace allow for seamless document sharing and data collection during group assignments. Mastering these browser-based tools ensures I can remain productive and collaborative regardless of my hardware setup.

Task 4 : Email Etiquette

As a Digital Ambassador, I drafted two professional emails—one requesting a deadline extension and another inquiring about an internship—to demonstrate proper tone and structure. Both drafts prioritize clarity, using specific subject lines and formal sign-offs. I also developed a Social Media Do’s and Don’ts checklist to guide peers toward responsible online behavior.

Reflecting on digital communication, I considered a scenario where a student used overly casual language in a formal inquiry. This lack of etiquette often leads to misunderstandings or a loss of professional credibility. What could have been done differently is the application of the Double -Check Rule: verifying the recipient's title and ensuring the tone remains respectful throughout the body of the email. This task reinforced that professional communication is as much about respect as it is about the information being shared.

The Cost of Digital Miscommunication

A common situation where poor digital communication causes real problems is the misinterpretation of tone in professional emails. In one instance, a manager sent a brief, all caps message: "WE NEED THE PROJECT BY 5 PM." Without the context of vocal tone or body language, the team interpreted this as aggressive and

panicked. This led to high stress, a rushed final product with several errors, and a breakdown in team morale.

To prevent this, the manager could have used better digital etiquette. Instead of all caps which is digitally perceived as shouting they could have used a collaborative tone: "Hi team, just a reminder that the deadline is 5 PM today. Let me know if you need any support." Additionally, for urgent or complex requests, a quick video call would have provided the necessary clarity and emotional context that text lacks.

Task 5 : Cybercrime

My research focused on UPI/Online Payment Fraud, which is a growing threat to students in India. I developed a case study detailing how scammers use psychological triggers to manipulate victims into sharing sensitive financial details. What surprised me most during this research was the sheer speed at which a single fraudulent link can compromise a user's entire digital identity.

As a direct result of this project, I will personally change my habit of using the same password across multiple academic portals and will begin using two-factor authentication wherever possible. I have also learned the importance of immediate reporting via the National Cyber Crime Portal (1930). This module has shifted my perspective from being a passive internet user to an active, security-conscious digital citizen who can now guide others in staying safe online.

Conclusion

This project has been a transformative experience in understanding the multifaceted nature of digital literacy. Beyond just technical skills, I have learned the importance of maintaining a professional persona, collaborating effectively in the cloud, and protecting my digital assets against emerging threats. As I move forward in my B.Tech journey, the GitHub repository I have built will serve as a permanent foundation for my professional career.

References

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